irregular quadrangle itself may have been a repurposed caravanserai or other structure; thereafter, it underwent at least five phases of modification, the penultimate one being the addition of a large royal oratory on the western perimeter (approximately where the modern shrine stood): Giunta 2010b: 123–125; Giunta 2020: 164ff.; Allegranzi 2014: 111–112; Allegranzi 2019a, vol. I: 54–56; Allegranzi 2020a; Ball and Fischer 2019: 475–477; Laviola 2020: 28–29; and Appendix, Afghanistan V: 2.

22. Some of these finds had already been inventoried in the 1950s Italian Archaeological Missions to Ghazna, e.g., Scerrato 1959: fig.18. See also Giunta 2005: 479–480 and fig. 5; Artusi 2009: 121–122 (quoting Scerrato), 128; Laviola 2018. See also Appendix, Afghanistan V: 4.
23. The marble dado panels recovered from the palace's main entrance area have been interpreted as part of a decorative and epigraphic program specific to this part of the complex; cf. Appendix, Afghanistan V: 1. They are stylistically related to the dadoes from the central court, and generally dated to the same period (Appendix, Afghanistan V: 3–4). See Flury 1925: 74; Giunta 2010b: 125.
24. See esp. Giunta 2010b: 126–127; Allegranzi 2020a.
25. Cf. esp. Bombaci 1966: 19–29; also Giunta 2005: 478ff.; Giunta 2010b: 126–127. O'Kane (2009: 22–23 and n. 72) followed Bombaci's initial study of the dado slabs and characterized them as a (fabricated) genealogy of the Ghaznavid sultans beginning in pre-Islamic Iran, referencing *Shah-nama*. Recent re-examination of the slabs, and the recovery of others that had been repurposed as tomb markers, reveal other possibilities: there was likely more than one poetic composition comprising the inscriptional bands, and the genres of both the lengthy *mathnavi* and the panegyric *qasida* were likely represented. Notably, references to Islamic juridical and theological ideas indicate that at least some of the subject matter was religious and/or political in nature. Cf. Allegranzi 2015: 26ff; Allegranzi 2019a, vol. I:145–167; Allegranzi 2020a.
26. Scerrato 1962: 265–267.
27. See esp. Allen 1988: 55–58; Allen 1990: 26; Ball and Fischer 2019: 469–471.
28. Juzjani simply noted that "Mu'izz al-Din subdued the environs of Ghazna," and that the following year (AH 570/1175 CE) he conquered Gardiz. Cf. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 396 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 449).
29. Although hesitant to consider this urban configuration as a "peculiarity" of Khurasan, Rante (2015: 17–20) brought attention to this overall layout in the development of several settlements throughout the vast region, ranging from Marv through Nishapur and dating from the Achaemenid through late Sasanian periods (first–seventh centuries; cf. also Collinet 2015: 127–128 and fig. 3; Laleh et al., 2015: 118; Ball, Glenn et al., 2019: 272–283). With the Arab conquests of Central Asia during the eighth century, further quarters (Ar. *rabad*) emerged to distribute the settled and incoming populations, with the Arabs usually within the enclaves. For early Islamic Afghanistan, see Franke 2015: esp. 81–84 and figs. 5, 27; Ball 2019: e.g., Nos. 99, 522, 874, 1006.
30. See Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 63ff.; Allen 1988: 58–60; Ball and Fischer 2019: 474, 544; Ball 2019: No. 149.